Prepositions of place and time

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Say where things are with prepositions of place (dónde está algo)
- Use in, on, under, next to, between, behind, in front of and opposite
- Say when things happen with in, on and at
- Give simple directions and describe a room

Para pensar

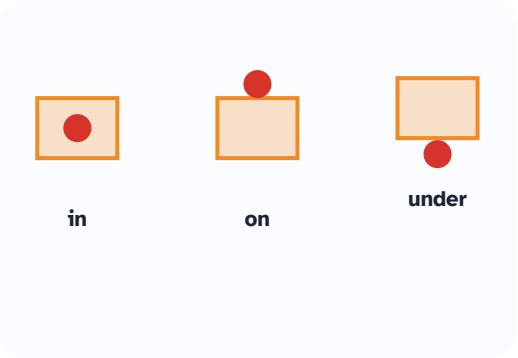
En castellano decimos «en la mesa», «en abril» y «el lunes». En inglés, ¿«en» siempre es *in*?

Explicación

Where is it?

Prepositions of place tell us **where** something is. The basic ones are: **in** (dentro de): «The pencil is **in** the pencil case.» **on** (encima de, tocando): «The book is **on** the desk.» **under** (debajo de): «The cat is **under** the bed.»

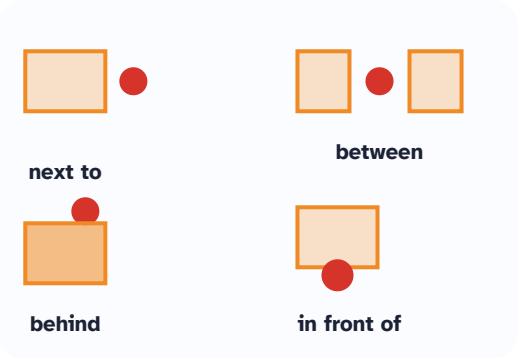
We ask with **Where is...?** or **Where are...?**: «Where are my trainers?» «They're **under** the sofa!» **En castellano:** «en» puede ser *in* o *on*. Pregúntate: ¿está dentro o encima?



Next to, between, behind...

More prepositions of place: **next to** (al lado de): «Lucas sits **next to** Emma.» **between** (entre dos cosas): «The bank is **between** the bakery and the pharmacy.» **behind** (detrás de): «The garden is **behind** the house.» **in front of** (delante de): «There's a tree **in front of** my window.»

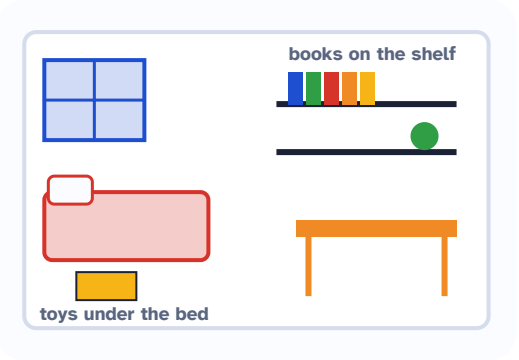
opposite (enfrente de, al otro lado): «The school is **opposite** the park.» **near** (cerca de): «I live **near** the beach.» **Ojo:** *in front of* es «delante de», no «enfrente».



Describing my bedroom

Prepositions are perfect to describe a **room**. «My bed is **next to** the window. There's a rug **on** the floor and a box of toys **under** the bed. My desk is **opposite** the door. My books are **on** the shelf, **between** the lamp and the plant. My clothes are **in** the wardrobe... well, some of them are **on** the chair!»

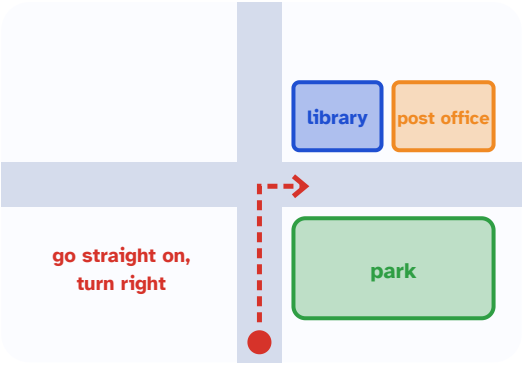
Use **There is** (one) and **There are** (more than one): «**There are** two posters **on** the wall.» «**There is** a clock **above** the door.» **above** = encima, sin tocar.



Giving directions

In a town we use prepositions to **give directions**. Useful phrases: **go straight on** (sigue recto), **turn left** (gira a la izquierda), **turn right** (a la derecha), **take the first street on the left**, **cross the road** (cruza la calle).

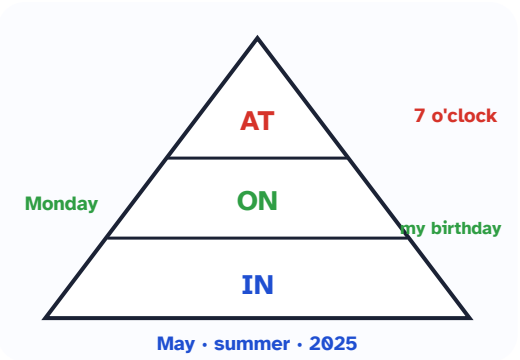
«Excuse me, where's the library?» «Go straight on and turn right. The library is **next to** the post office, **opposite** the park.» «Thank you!» Remember to be polite: start with **Excuse me** and finish with **Thank you**.



When? In, on and at

Prepositions of time tell us **when**. The three most important are **in**, **on** and **at**. Think of a pyramid. **In** is for big periods: months, seasons, years and centuries: **in** May, **in** winter, **in** 2015, **in** the 21st century.

On is for days and dates: **on** Monday, **on** my birthday, **on** 3rd June, **on** Christmas Day. **At** is for exact times: **at** seven o'clock, **at** half past four, **at** midnight, and also **at** the weekend and **at** night.



Parts of the day

Be careful with the parts of the day. We say **in the morning**, **in the afternoon** and **in the evening**, but **at night**. «I have English **in the morning**.» «We go to the park **in the afternoon**.» «Owls hunt **at night**.»

If we add a day, we use **on**: «**on** Monday morning», «**on** Saturday night». And with **this, next, last, every** we don't use any preposition: «I'll see you **next** Friday», «We play **every** Tuesday», «I went **last** summer».

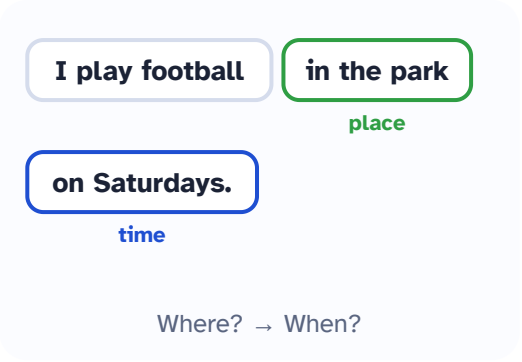
in the morning	por la mañana
in the afternoon	por la tarde
in the evening	al atardecer
at night	por la noche

Time and place together

Many sentences have **both**: where and when. The usual order in English is: place first, then time. «I play football **in the park on Saturdays**.» «We had lunch **at my**

grandma's at two o'clock.» «My cousin was born **in Seville in 2016**.»

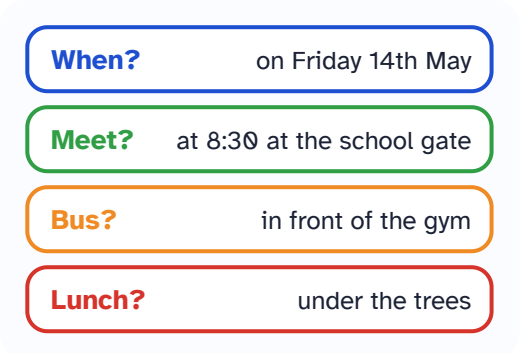
Truco: «¿Dónde? ¿Cuándo?», en ese orden. También podemos poner el tiempo al principio para destacarlo: «**On Saturdays**, I play football in the park».



Reading: the school trip

Read the note from the teacher: «Dear families, our school trip to the Natural Park is **on** Friday 14th May. We meet **at** the school gate **at** half past eight **in** the morning. The bus stops **in front of** the gym. At the park, we will have lunch **under** the big trees, **next to** the river. The information centre is **opposite** the car park. We come back **at** five o'clock **in** the afternoon. Please put a hat and a water bottle **in** your child's bag.»

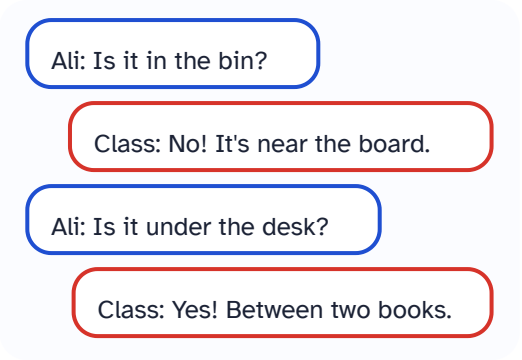
When is the trip? Where does the bus stop? Where will they have lunch?



Let's practise: hide and find

Play «Where's the rubber?» One student hides a rubber in the classroom while another waits outside. Then the class gives clues: «It's **near** the board. It's **under** something. It's **between** two books.»

Second game: **«My week»**. Tell your partner three activities with **in, on, at**: «I have swimming **on** Tuesday **at** six. In summer I go to the village.» **Repaso:** lugar: in, on, under, next to, between, behind, in front of, opposite. Tiempo: in (mes, año), on (día), at (hora).



Prepositions

place	place	time	time
IN · ON	**UNDER**	**IN · ON**	**AT**
in the box on the table	next to, between behind, opposite	in May on Monday	at 7 o'clock at night

Ejercicios

1. **Complete: «The milk is ___ the fridge.»**

2. **Complete: «The picture is ___ the wall.»**

3. **Complete: «The dog sleeps ___ the table.» (debajo)**

4. **Complete: «The B is ___ the A and the C.»**

5. **Complete with in, on or at: «___ summer», «___ Sunday», «___ 6 o'clock».**

6. **Complete: «I read ___ night and I run ___ the morning.»**

7. **Correct: «I was born on 2015 in July.»**

8. **Translate: «La farmacia está enfrente del colegio.»**

9. **Give directions: go up the street and turn left.**

10. **Describe your desk in three sentences.**

Practica

1. **«The cat is ___ the box.» (dentro)**
   - **A)** on
   - **B)** at
   - **C)** in
2. **«The lamp is ___ the desk.» (encima)**
   - **A)** on
   - **B)** in
   - **C)** at
3. **«Opposite» means...**
   - **A)** delante de
   - **B)** enfrente de
   - **C)** detrás de
4. **«In front of» means...**
   - **A)** enfrente de
   - **B)** delante de
   - **C)** al lado de
5. **«___ Monday»**
   - **A)** in
   - **B)** at
   - **C)** on
6. **«___ 2020»**
   - **A)** in
   - **B)** on
   - **C)** at
7. **«___ half past three»**
   - **A)** in
   - **B)** on
   - **C)** at
8. **«___ night»**
   - **A)** in

B) at

C) on

9. **«The bank is ___ the shop and the café.»**

A) between

B) next

C) under

10. **Which is correct?**

A) I play tennis in the park on Saturdays.

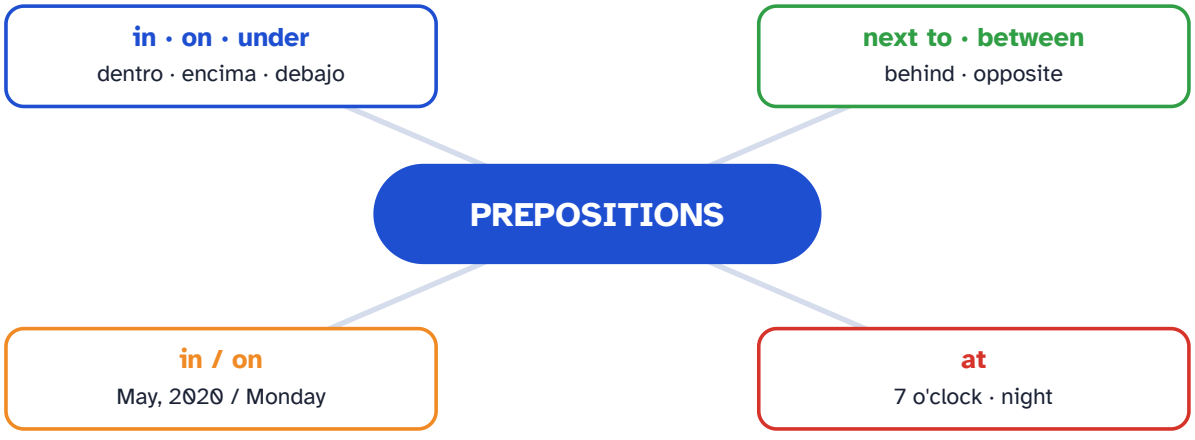
B) I play tennis on Saturdays in park.

C) I play tennis at Saturdays in the park.

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Qué preposiciones de lugar hay y qué significa cada una; Cuál es la diferencia entre in front of y opposite; Cuándo se usa in, on y at para el tiempo; En qué orden se pone el lugar y el tiempo.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

in

Dentro de · meses y años.

on

Encima de · días y fechas.

at

Horas exactas · at night.

under

Debajo de.

next to

Al lado de.

between

Entre dos cosas.

in front of

Delante de.

opposite

Enfrente de.

Soluciones

1. **C)** Dentro: in.
2. **A)** Encima tocando: on.
3. **B)** Al otro lado.
4. **B)** Delante.
5. **C)** Días: on.
6. **A)** Años: in.
7. **C)** Horas: at.
8. **B)** At night.
9. **A)** Entre dos cosas.
10. **A)** Lugar y luego tiempo.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. in.
2. on.
3. under.
4. between.
5. in summer, on Sunday, at 6 o'clock.
6. at night, in the morning.
7. I was born in July 2015. / I was born in 2015.
8. The pharmacy is opposite the school.
9. Go straight on and turn left.
10. Model answer: My pencil case is on the desk. My bag is under the desk. The lamp is next to the books.